GYR-O Pages: call card

Devan Cherie Costa-Cargill · Wyoming SBDC, Powell · Fri 23 Oct, 1:00–1:30 · 307-254-7755 · dcostaca@uwyo.edu

THE ONE QUESTION

"Who at the University should I speak to, to have this reviewed?"

"If one of the PhD researchers there could review it, we'd be on the same wavelength, speaking the same language."

Send her to washakie-ai.online. The maroon link at the very top, "Abstract for our meeting today," opens the one-page summary (washakie-ai.online/uw.html).

SAY FIRST, ABOUT A MINUTE

- "Thanks for the time. I'm Walter Wilkinson, a retired technology engineer in Worland."
- "On June 3 of this year Governor Gordon issued an executive order calling for state agencies to promote data centers, the buildings AI runs on. But it looks like the state's AI money will be going to Cheyenne and Laramie. Here in Washakie County we will not be building any colossal data centers, and will not be hosting any AI researchers. My proposal answers the question: how can we bring AI to the grass-roots level?"
- "AI does the heavy lifting: simple single-topic websites, where the owner just picks a name. Three are live. If you open washakie-ai.online, today's abstract is the link at the very top. The technology is working now. What I'm looking for is the next step: the right people at UW, and funding for a county pilot."

Then stop talking. Let her ask. Before hanging up: one next step on the calendar.

ASK, IN THIS ORDER

1. **The one question** (above). Ideas if she asks: Extension; the AI Initiative; Gabrielle Allen, School of Computing. Would you introduce me?
2. **Market research.** Can the SBDC run it on this, free? What do you need from me?
3. **Sponsor.** Which Washakie County body has sponsored a Business Council grant before, and who there?
4. **Is the grant open?** The $10,000 Community Economic Growth Grant page still says "reopening by January 2024."
5. **If not that grant,** what is the right one for a $10,000 rural technology pilot?

IF SHE ASKS "BUSINESS OR COMMUNITY PROGRAM?"

> **"A business. The school pilot is the market test; the grant would fund the pilot."**

IN MY POCKET, ONLY IF IT COMES UP

- **Cost to an owner:** hosting free; the name $11–$28 a year; a farm cooperative can share one name.
- **The pilot:** 12 months, 12 working sites, 4 public workshops, method published free.
- **Students** do the demonstrations and gather feedback; they don't build the sites.
- **SBIR/STTR:** federal research grants. STTR needs a university partner; ask, don't count on it.
- **Numbers behind the rural point:** Governor Gordon's executive order, 3 June 2026; 1.8 GW data center approved in Laramie County; about $4M NSF to UW's AI4WY.

GYR-O PAGES · WORLAND, WASHAKIE COUNTY

GYR-O Pages and the UW AI Initiative

ONE OF THE UW PRESIDENT'S INITIATIVES: THE AI INITIATIVE, IN ITS OWN WORDS

"The University of Wyoming's AI Initiative is a bold, people-centered effort to shape the future of our state, empowering citizens and communities to thrive in an AI-driven world. By addressing key industries like agriculture, engineering, energy, tourism, wildlife conservation, and rural healthcare, UW is ensuring that AI enriches lives and drives sustainable growth. This initiative will enhance the University of Wyoming's ability to bring advances in AI to disciplines across the university to advance the state. It will attract investments, build corporate partnerships, seed entrepreneurship, and equip every student and community to participate in the global AI transformation, securing a prosperous future for all of Wyoming."

Source: uwyo.edu › Office of the President › Initiatives › AI Initiative

Why GYR-O Pages fits

"People-centered"	The owner describes what they want in their own words, and AI builds it.
"Empowering citizens and communities"	No training, no software, almost no cost. The site is theirs outright.
"Seed entrepreneurship"	Farms, shops and small offices get a working website of their own.
"Agriculture"	Farm sites, shared under a farm cooperative's name.
"Equip every student and community"	Public workshops, with high school ambassadors doing the demonstrations.
"All of Wyoming"	Built for a county of 7,600, far from Laramie and Cheyenne.
Ready now	Three sites live. A 12-month Washakie County pilot for about $10,000.

The question I'm asking: who at the University should I speak to, to have this reviewed?

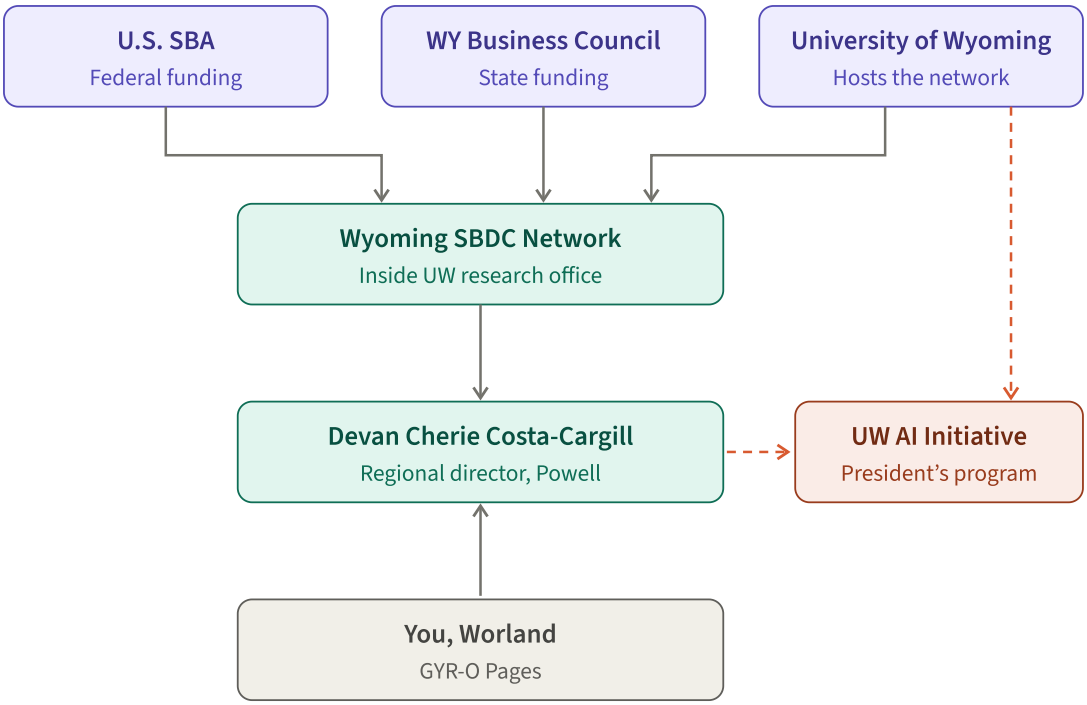
> See it working: the top of washakie-ai.online takes about a minute to read.

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The quotation above is the University of Wyoming's; the summary below it is the author's, from AI.

Wyoming SBDC: who funds it, and the UW connection

How Devan Cherie Costa-Cargill's office connects to the University of Wyoming



Solid arrows: the money and the organization. The SBA funds the network through a cooperative agreement, the Wyoming Business Council adds state funds, and UW hosts it under the Office of Research and Economic Development.
Dashed arrows: the connection to make. The AI Initiative is a separate UW program run from the President's office; Devan Cherie, inside the same university, can make the introduction.

What "hosting" means

- **The University holds the federal agreement.** The SBA signs its cooperative agreement with a host organization, usually a university, rather than with the network itself. In Wyoming that host is UW, and the network sits under its Office of Research and Economic Development.
- **The staff are University employees.** Hence Devan Cherie's uwyo.edu address: her paycheck, office systems and email come through UW, though she works from Powell.
- **The host must match the federal money.** Federal law requires at least one non-federal dollar for each SBA dollar; the Wyoming Business Council's state funds and UW's own contributions supply it.
- **The host runs the business side:** accounting, reporting to the SBA, hiring, and the regional offices around the state.

These are the general rules of the national SBDC program; not every Wyoming detail has been confirmed.

Source: UW News, "New $2.5 Million Grant to Help Wyoming Entrepreneurs Access Critical Resources" (November 2021), uwyo.edu. The arrangement may have changed since.